JJAS 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 May 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

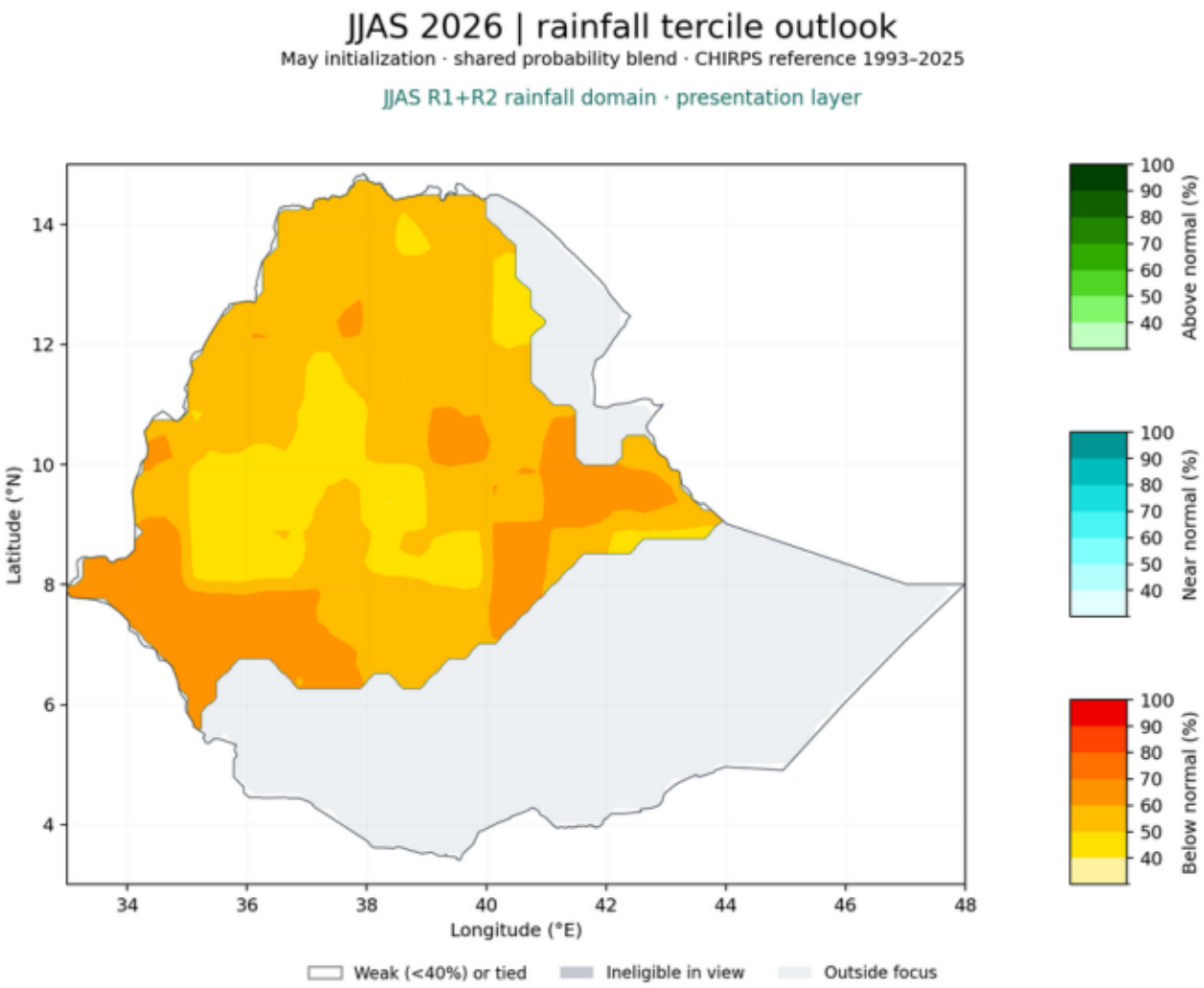
The forecast leans toward below normal rainfall in the JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of below normal is 55%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 614 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 715 mm (−101 mm, −14%).

Below normal 55% **Near normal 25%** **Above normal 20%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Strong tilt toward below normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain): Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero). Probability skill (RPSS) +0.078, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval +0.018 to +0.137; better than climatology in 19 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12×; Gaussian σ=0.6 native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a May-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

JJAS 2026 — May initialization · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
JJAS 2026	55% / 25% / 20%	100%	−101 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Sep 2026 file not found (checked 10 Oct 2026)
Jun 2026	43% / 30% / 27%	98%	−22 mm	Verification published
Jul 2026	43% / 30% / 27%	100%	−24 mm	Verification published
Aug 2026	48% / 27% / 25%	100%	−27 mm	Verification published
Sep 2026	39% / 31% / 30%	100%	−24 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Sep 2026 file not found (checked 10 Oct 2026)

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
JJAS	+0.078 (+0.018 to +0.137)	19/24	0.055	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Jun	+0.018 (−0.027 to +0.057)	16/24	0.453	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Jul	+0.034 (+0.007 to +0.059)	18/24	0.055	Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Aug	+0.027 (−0.001 to +0.055)	16/24	0.122	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Sep	+0.006 (−0.014 to +0.028)	14/24	0.453	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
Jun 2026	+0.217	+0.399	+9.8 mm	−22 / −32 mm	80% / 15% / 5%
Jul 2026	+0.196	+0.253	+33.6 mm	−24 / −58 mm	84% / 11% / 5%
Aug 2026	+0.356	+0.440	+20.6 mm	−27 / −47 mm	88% / 10% / 2%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 May 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Jun 2026 – 30 Sep 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 4 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 JJAS 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: August 2026 (Jun, Jul, Aug)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 5 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.50 for JJAS) · code 50ca522

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

JJAS 2026 — May initialization · JJAS R1+R2 rainfall domain

